

Volleyball Pregame Neural Warm-Up

6–8 minutes

"Stretching gets you loose. Neural warm-ups get you sharp." — Dr. Shah

This is **SEE** → **DECIDE** → **MOVE**, at game speed.

1

Monocular Eye Control

30–45 sec

Why: Reduces eye dominance issues → better ball tracking, cleaner reads on tips and float serves

How

- Cover one eye
- With the open eye, trace this pattern in space or on the wall:
 - Up left → up right
 - Middle left → middle right
 - Down left → down right
- Hit each corner once
- Switch eyes

Coaching cue

"Smooth eyes. No rushing. No head movement."

If one eye feels jumpy, you just found a performance leak before first serve.

2

Saccades: Horizontal + Vertical

45–60 sec

Why: Fast ball-to-setter-to-hitter reads, blocker timing, serve-receive reactions

How

- Two fingers at eye level
- Horizontal: left ↔ right (20–30 reps)
- Vertical: up ↑ down (20–30 reps)
- Head still, jaw relaxed

Coaching cue

"Eyes snap. Face stays quiet."

■ If the head moves → nervous system already compensating.

3

Depth Perception Switch (Thumb Near–Far Cycling)

45–60 sec

Why: Volleyball is constant **near-far depth switching** (hands → ball → hitter → ball)

How

- Thumb at arm's length
- **Look past your thumb** → let it double
- **Look in front of your thumb** → let the background double
- Move back and forth smoothly
- **10 controlled cycles**

Coaching cue

"Clear → double → clear. Own the switch."

*This trains **active depth control**, not passive focusing.*

4

VOR + Cossack Squat with Reach

60 sec

Why: Eye stability while dropping low, lateral coverage, defensive saves

How

- Thumb at arm's length
- Lock eyes on thumb
- Rotate head side-to-side
- Perform slow Cossack squats
- **Add a ground touch** at the bottom, then return upright
- 5–6 reps each side

Coaching cue

"Eyes stay locked. Body moves underneath."

5

Volleyball Juggle + Dynamic Movement

90 sec

Why: Tracking under fatigue + posture control + ball awareness

How

- Keep volleyball in the air using light taps
- Progression:
 1. **Solo touches- Keeping it up and in place** (eyes up, no staring)
 2. Keep it up → **Cossack squat touch ground** → recover → juggle
 3. Keep it up → **lunge right with tap** → recover → **lunge left with tap**
- Keep eyes up the whole time

Coaching cue

"See the ball without chasing it."

This mimics broken plays and scramble points.

6

Peripheral Hand Motion

60 sec

Why: Libero reads, blocker awareness, setter deception detection

How

- Eyes forward on a fixed point (Nose of partner- Soften Gaze)
- Partner or coach moves hands in peripheral field
- Athlete follows partners hand movements without moving eyes off the nose
 - Keep motions random and increasing difficulty
- Progress to **asymmetric motion** (one fast, one slow)

Coaching cue

"Don't look at it. Detect it."

7

Quiet-Eye Reset

30–45 sec

Why: Settles chaos before first serve, improves timing and decision accuracy

How

- Pick a small spot on the net tape or antenna
- Soft focus
- Nasal breathing
- 4-sec inhale / 6–8-sec exhale × 5 breaths

Coaching cue

"Calm eyes. Calm brain."